Abdullah Al Zahid

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Human Resources
Toronto Port Authority, Billy Bishop Toronto City Airport

Re: Project Lead, Airport Comprehensive Plan (18-month contract)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Project Lead position on the Airport Comprehensive Plan. I come to it from transportation planning rather than airport work, so I want to be clear about what I would bring and where I fall short.

The plan sits in the Infrastructure, Planning and Environment team and draws on transportation, land use and stakeholder input. At the City of Toronto I analyze travel and network data to establish where capacity falls short, review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, and write the briefing notes and presentations that carry findings to senior staff and outside agencies. I coordinate with divisions, consultants and agencies whose priorities conflict, and I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule myself. Testing whether a design will cope with the demand placed on it is what I have done with simulation, at Mott MacDonald on Ontario Line construction staging and at Metrolinx on GO rail services.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. I have also worked in AutoCAD and Civil 3D.

The gaps are significant. The posting asks for ten to twelve years of experience on airport projects, and I have none; my professional experience is closer to four and a half years. I have not managed a project budget, overseen consultants under a procurement process, or led consultation with Indigenous communities or the public, and I have not worked on Environmental or Impact Assessments. I am not bilingual in French. I am applying because the planning and analysis underneath the role is work I do now, and in case the team would consider someone who is still building airport experience.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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